

Reading Graphs

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Study the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

CUE FOCUS Before you read any graph, read three things first: the **title** (what it shows), the **labels** on each side, and the **key** or **scale**. A **bar graph** uses bars; read the height against the scale. A **pictograph** uses pictures; the key tells how many each picture stands for. A **dot plot** stacks one dot for each item above a number line; count the dots.

Round 1 — Retrieve It

1. What three things should you read first on any graph?

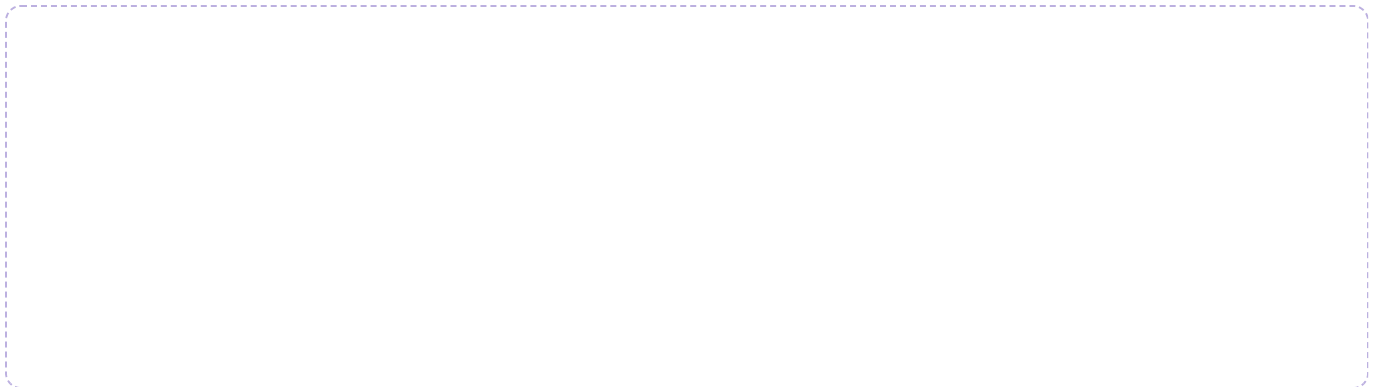
2. On a bar graph, what do you read to find how many a bar stands for?

3. On a pictograph, what does the key tell you?

4. On a dot plot, how do you find how many items are at one number?

Round 2 — Sketch It

Draw a small pictograph titled “Books Read.” Make a key that says 1 picture = 2 books. Show Maria with 6 books and Sam with 4 books.



Reading Graphs — Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Answer first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 — Apply the Idea

1. A bar graph of pets has these bars: Dogs 8, Cats 5, Fish 3. How many more dogs than fish are there? Show how you know.

2. A pictograph key says 1 star = 5 stickers. Ana's row has 4 stars. How many stickers does Ana have? Show your work.

3. A dot plot shows shoe sizes: size 2 has 1 dot, size 3 has 4 dots, size 4 has 2 dots. How many students in all? Which size is most common?

Round 4 — Reason from Evidence

Two classes each made a pictograph of juice boxes sold. Room A used a key of 1 box = 2, Room B used a key of 1 box = 5. Both rows have the same number of pictures. Did both rooms sell the same amount? Explain why the key matters.

Reading Graphs — ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A**Articulate**

Explain how a bar graph, a pictograph, and a dot plot are different. Use the words scale, key, and dots.

C**Connect**

Connect graphs to something you have seen, such as a chart in class or a score board. Tell what its title and labels told you.

E**Extend**

Ten friends voted for a favorite fruit. Choose a key for a pictograph and explain why that key is a good choice for the number 10.

Confidence check. Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it.

Teacher Key — Reading Graphs

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. The title, the labels, and the key or scale.
2. The scale (the numbers along the side).
3. How many each picture stands for.
4. Count the dots stacked above that number.

Sketch It — look for

Title “Books Read,” a key of 1 picture = 2 books, Maria’s row with 3 pictures (6 books), and Sam’s row with 2 pictures (4 books).

Apply It

1. 5 more dogs than fish ($8 - 3 = 5$).
2. 20 stickers ($4 \times 5 = 20$).
3. 7 students in all ($1 + 4 + 2$); size 3 is most common.

Reason from Evidence — look for

No. Same number of pictures does not mean the same amount because the keys differ. Room B ($1 = 5$) sold more per picture than Room A ($1 = 2$), so you must multiply by the key before comparing.

ACE — Extend look-for

A key such as 1 picture = 2 works well for 10 (it makes 5 whole pictures with no leftovers). Reasonable keys with a clear explanation are fine.

Suggested use. Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color.